

# Laboratory safety checklist

Cells and Scientific Enquiry

**Inkwell**

Read this before every practical session. Tick each line as you check it.

## Before you start

- ☐ Read the method and the hazard notes
- ☐ Tie back long hair and loose clothing
- ☐ Wear safety glasses when told to
- ☐ Know where the eye wash and fire blanket are
- ☐ Keep bags off the bench and the floor clear
- ☐ Check glassware for cracks

## During the practical

- ☐ Never eat or drink in the laboratory
- ☐ Point test tubes away from people when heating
- ☐ Use the correct volumes; never taste or sniff directly
- ☐ Report spills and breakages immediately
- ☐ Stay at your station with your equipment

## After you finish

- ☐ Turn off gas, water and electrical equipment
- ☐ Dispose of waste in the correct containers
- ☐ Clean and dry your bench
- ☐ Wash your hands with soap

## Hazard symbols to recognise

| Symbol               | Meaning                 |
|----------------------|-------------------------|
| Flame                | Flammable               |
| Corrosion            | Damages skin and metals |
| Exclamation mark     | Irritant or harmful     |
| Skull and crossbones | Toxic                   |

## In an emergency

Tell your teacher at once. For chemicals in the eye, rinse with running water for at least ten minutes.